

Super Gateway

The world's second fastest supercomputer has just arrived, and it does not stay in a lab. Gateway, the PC maker, has just announced that its 8,000 computers located at Gateway stores all over the US will now work, instead of hibernating.

After joining forces with United Devices, using their Alliance MetaProcessor platform, the 8,000 PC-grid based supercomputer is capable of an incredible 14 TFLOPs. Compare this with the world's fastest supercomputer yet, the Earth Simulator that clocks in at 35.61 TFLOPs. The next nearest number cruncher clocks in at a comparatively smaller 7.23 TFLOPs. This means that the Gateway/United Devices supercomputing grid, called the Platform On Demand (POD), is now the Number Two supercomputer on the Top 500 Supercomputer list.

The Alliance MetaProcessor platform protects the network with data encryption, firewalls and intrusion prevention methods and secure grid implementation. This secure supercomputer is available immediately for use to a variety of industries, including life sciences, geosciences, nanosciences, entertainment, financial services and more.

snapshot

Out of **29** advisories published by CERT during the first 10 months of 2002, Linux software accounted for **16** and Microsoft for only **7**

Source: Aberdeen Group

followup

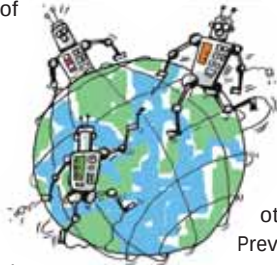
AI on the Internet

Artificial Intelligence will soon be everybody's cup of tea and you can be a part of the research for implementing AI. Researchers have finally conceded that the quest for AI is too daunting for a single group, and are looking at the formidable resources of the Internet for help.

World Wide Mind, a research team run by Mark Humphrys at Dublin City University, says that for AI to advance, the entire field needs to be democratised. To harness

the power of developers and novices worldwide, Humphry's team has developed an interactive program that lets them post their research on the Net for others to use.

Previously, AI research focussed on creating entire robotic systems that could 'sense' the world. But the new shift is in creating logical subsystems or modules, that are used in vision, navigation, locomotion, and problem solving among others.



Google for pinstripes

Google has now yet another distinction—it provides many Web-based businesses with a steady supply of customers. Numerous small Web-based service providers and entrepreneurs are now dependent on Google for their customer base. For example, if you were looking for yacht charters at the British Virgin



Islands, you could possibly end up looking up Bareboats-BVI, a site that gets most of its customers over from Google. The yacht broker does not end up paying anything to Google, but still relies on it for income.

Google uses many variables in its automated ranking process but the popular one bases its ranking on the number of sites that link to it. These links spell the number of endorsements. Google regularly shuffles

its rankings to reflect changes in its own methods or in the Web's link structure and content. This way, many small time independent businesses that would get lost in the World Wide Web, get fair exposure. But, Google can be very aggressive when it comes to customers using unfair means. Sometimes a site's ranking lowers dramatically or even disappears altogether if Google detects some evidence that the site's owner was using deceptive tactics such as building a network of linked sites to create the illusion of popularity and thereby receiving a higher ranking.

But the free lunch may soon come to an end—big businesses are spending more money into making sure that their site listings are optimised. Google doesn't make any money out of this—although sponsored site links are posted, these are not ranked, they appear as separate links.



heroes

Low-price PCs

Wal-Mart Stores Inc is offering a computer at \$199 (approx Rs 10,000) with neither Microsoft software nor Intel hardware. The Wal-Mart machines are full-fledged computers without Windows. Its sales, largely from technology enthusiasts, businesses and schools, are already exceeding expectations.

Robotics

Leif Askeland, an icon in the toy industry, has created a robotic lap cat named FurReal Friends that will appeal to retailers, parents and children. The furry robot purrs when petted and presses its face into your hand if its cheeks are rubbed.



zeroes

Microsoft applications

Sun Microsystems announced a deal on December 4, 2002, to install StarOffice on some European Sony PCs, marking another defection from dominant Microsoft products. Corel had earlier announced deals to put its WordPerfect software on PCs from HP and the North American wing of Sony.

eBay

Fraudsters are tricking legitimate users of eBay into handing over their identities to set up bogus auction accounts. The scammers rely on good ratings earned by the legitimate users to make their own bogus auctions look respectable.



■ ATi coming with R400, possibly with GDER 3 memory, by summer ■ Gateway ties with pressplay to offer 2,000 songs pre-loaded on new PCs